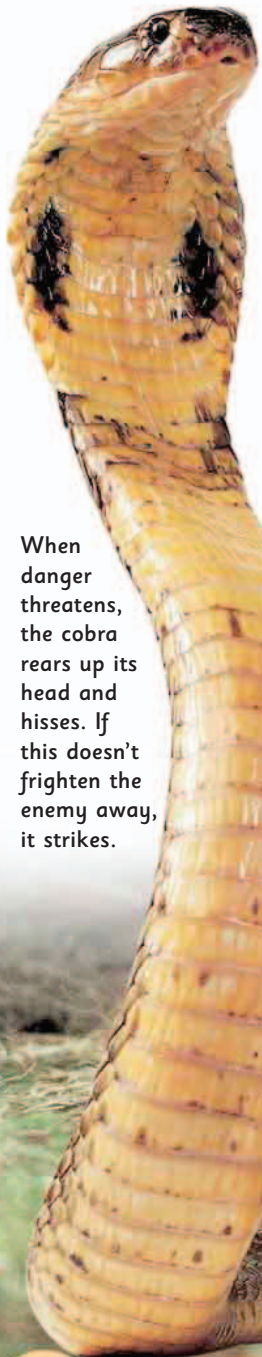


Attack and defence

All snakes eat animals, including smaller snakes. But other animals also find snakes a tasty meal, so they have to be experts at defending themselves as well as hunting for food.



When danger threatens, the cobra rears up its head and hisses. If this doesn't frighten the enemy away, it strikes.



Protection

Snakes have various ways to protect themselves. Some snakes, such as the forest pit viper above, have long fangs containing deadly venom. When threatened, they bite.

Forms of defence

Snakes have many other defences that protect them from enemies.



Playing dead: the grass snake lies with its mouth open pretending to be dead.



Camouflage: this viper's colouring camouflages it among the leaves.



Rattlers: the rattlesnake shakes its tail making a loud warning noise.

Attack

Cobras are among the most dangerous snakes on Earth; their venom can easily kill humans. This spitting cobra squirts venom at its victims, which can permanently blind them.

Spitting cobra

